

Board 1

West Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 10 9 3
♥ 10 5 4
♦ K J 10
♣ A K Q

♠ 8 7
♥ A Q 9 8 6 2
♦ Q 7
♣ 7 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 5 4 2
♥ J
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ A K J
♥ K 7 3
♦ A 6 5 2
♣ 8 6 4

West	North	East	South
1NT	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			
Lead: ♣J			

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♣J. West wins
♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

West takes ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

West opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and East has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and ♦K are with West and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already rectified.

You plan to squeeze West by running the long ♥s in your hand, but the problem is that the ♦Q is not a Threat card yet. To make it a Threat you need to unblock dummy's ♦A. So play the ♦A, then pull trumps with the ♥A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to West.

Play the ♥9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. West is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

[showcards N:SA,SK,SJ,D6 E:SQ,ST,S9,DK S:S8,S7,H6,DQ W:S6,S5,D9,D8]

West is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

West can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not West.

If you discard the ♦6 West will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, West will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 2
 ♥ 9 3
 ♦ A K 8 6
 ♣ K Q 10 6 5

♠ K 9 8 4 3

♥ 10 8 6 2

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ -

N
 W E
 S

♠ Q 7
 ♥ A 4
 ♦ Q 5 4
 ♣ A J 9 7 3 2

♠ J 10 6 5

♥ K Q J 7 5

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	Pass
2 ♦	Pass	3 ♣	Pass
4 ♣	Pass	4 ♥	Pass
4 ♠	Pass	6 ♣	
All Pass			

6 ♣ by East

Lead: ♥K

♠Q is the Vienna Coup.

East is to play 6 ♣. South leads the ♥K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦ s also holds the ♠K and that a squeeze will be possible.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you should rectify the count, so you win the first trick, pull trumps in two rounds, then give up a ♥ trick.

South takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦9 which you win with your ♦Q.

You now make the key play of taking dummy's ♠A before running three rounds of ♣s.

[showcards N:S2,DA,DK,D8 E:SK,DJ,DT,D7 S:SQ,D5,D4,C7 W:SJ,ST,HQ,D2]

Unblocking the ♠A to create a Threat out of your

As you see, North was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣7 and discard dummy's ♠2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6 ♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥K.

Board 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9
♥ 10 5 3 2
♦ Q J 9 6 4 2
♣ 10 7

♠ A K Q 7 5 2
♥ 8 6 4
♦ 7 5
♣ 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 6
♥ 9 7
♦ 10 8 3
♣ J 9 8 4

♠ 4 3
♥ A K Q J
♦ A K
♣ A K Q 5 2

West	North	East	South
	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

7NT by South

Lead: ♦ Q
East follows twice, then discards 2 ♦ s.

Don't play ♠ s yet!

Play your ♦ A. East must give up.

If he throws the ♣ J, you win. But if he throws a ♠ you also win. This is what is called a Win-Win bridge play.

North's 3NT rebid shows 6 ♠ s headed by A K Q and nothing else. South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♦ Q.

Nice hand. You have 12 high card tricks and either a 3-2 ♠ split or a 3-3 ♣ split will land this Grand Slam. But even if neither suit splits nicely you can STILL make it if the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits; in that case you will squeeze for the thirteenth trick.

Win the ♦ K and (**IMPORTANT!**) test the ♣ s first by playing ♣ A K Q. Darn. West discards a ♦ on the ♣ Q.

Alright, so East holds the ♣ Guard. You still need to exercise caution.

Play your 4 ♥ winner's next. West follows suit while

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q J
 ♥ 9 5 3
 ♦ K Q
 ♣ 10 8 7 4

♠ 8 5 3

♥ Q 10 7 2

♦ J 10 8 4

♣ 6 3



♠ 10 6

♥ A K 8 6

♦ 9 7 3

♣ A K Q J

♠ 9 7 4 2

♥ J 4

♦ A 6 5 2

♣ 9 5 2

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	6NT	Pass
All Pass			
6NT by West			
Lead: ♦ J			

West is to play 6NT. North leads the ♦ J. South takes the ♦ A and returns the ♦ 2.

Your 4 ♠ tricks, 2 ♥ tricks, 1 ♦ trick and 4 ♣ tricks are very easy to find. But that's only 11, so where in the world can you possibly find number 12?

With all those high ♦ s falling on the first two tricks dummy's ♦ 9 has become a threat against North. If it should happen that North also holds the only ♥ stopper you can squeeze him in the red suits.

You are going to now run your black suit winners, but take the ♣ s first so you can be playing winners from your hand when you squeeze North.

On the last 2 ♣ s North discards a ♦ and a ♥ .

Now come to your hand with the ♠ A and play the ♠ K Q.

You discard a small ♥ from dummy while North follows suit three times.

[showcards N:HA,HK,H8,D9 E:S9,HJ,H4,D6 S:SJ,H9,H5,H3 W:HQ,HT,H7,DT]

It is time.

Play your ♠ J and watch what North discards.

If he holds on to the ♦ 10 you will discard dummy's useless ♦ 9 and hope the ♥ s all fall under the ♥ A K.

If he discards the ♦ 10 then you throw dummy's small ♥ and dummy wins the last three tricks.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 10 8 6
♥ A 8 4 2
♦ 5
♣ K 9 4 2

♠ 9 3
♥ K Q
♦ A K Q J 9 3
♣ Q 8 3



♠ 7 4 2
♥ J 10 9 6 3
♦ 8 6 4
♣ J 6

♠ A K Q 5
♥ 7 5
♦ 10 7 2
♣ A 10 7 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♥
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♥J			
Then start running the ♦ suit.			

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♥J. West wins the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

With only 11 winners you need to find one more and your prospects are quite slim.

No matter how the ♠s split only one defender will hold the Guard because only one defender can have as many as 4. IF (it's a big IF) that same defender holds the ♣K then you can squeeze him.

Can you see how the squeeze is going to work?

If you try to run your ♦s right away you will have a problem with your ♣Q later on. It will be no good as a Threat card because you will have no entry back to your hand.

The solution is the Vienna Coup. Play a ♣ to the ♣A at trick 3.

This is the situation after you have unblocked dummy's ♣A and then played 5 ♦ winners.

So far neither defender is hurting, but that is about to change.

You play your ♦3 and discard dummy's ♣10.

West is squeezed. He can't throw his ♣K without letting your ♣Q become a winner. But if he discards a ♠ dummy's ♠5 will win the last trick. This is soooo much fun.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 3
 ♥ K 9 8 6 3
 ♦ A 6
 ♣ A K Q 5

♠ A 8 5 2

♥ 4

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ J 10 9 3



♠ K 7
 ♥ A Q J 7 5 2
 ♦ J 5
 ♣ 7 6 4

♠ Q J 10 6 4

♥ 10

♦ 10 9 7 4 2

♣ 8 2

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	Pass
3 ♣	Pass	3 ♥	Pass
6 ♥			
All Pass			
6 ♥ by East			
Lead: ♠ Q			

Play 5 ♥ winners and the ♠ K.

Drum roll please.

Play your ♥ 2 and dump dummy's ♦ 6.

North has no answer.

East is to play 6 ♥. South leads the ♠ Q. North wins the ♠ A and plays the ♦ K.

Of course you have noticed that in most of these hands you are exactly one trick short. No coincidence - it's when you are one trick short and can't find another likely plan that you start to look for a squeeze.

In this hand dummy's fourth ♣ is an obvious Threat, so you should ask yourself if you can find another Threat for when ♣s don't split 3-3. Another thing you have probably noticed is that although 3-3 splits happen about 40% of the time in real life, they **NEVER** happen in these pages!

North's ♦ K play helps you find the other Threat. It appears that he must hold the ♦ Q also, so your ♦ J is now a Threat against North. If he holds 4 ♣s you can squeeze him.